



Paint in the Rain

By Anna Kirschberg

Illustrated by James Keiaho



Book Summary

This fictional story depicts a boy who enjoys painting in the rain. The author asks the reader to consider what it would be like to paint in the rain. As the character paints in the rain, he has fun and realizes the different effects the rain can have on his painting. Look at how the image he paints changes in the rain! Detailed and vibrant illustrations depict and help the text explain the story information about each page.

This book is the first book in the 12 book series of Sound Families (Fiction) decodable readers which covers long vowels (/ai/ /ee/ /igh/ /oa/ /oo/ and /y-oo/). There are two book titles for each sound. Within each reader, alternative spellings are provided (graphemes) for the target sound (phoneme).

The book title “Paint in the Rain” covers the long vowel sound family of /ai/, where alternative spellings are provided for /ai/: /ay/, /a/, /a-e/.

Skills and Strategies

Children can identify the target sound in the text quickly as they have been highlighted in bold in the text and then compare the spelling across the sound family. Other words included are decodable at the phase level as well as common exception words in accordance to the decodable progression.

Phase 5.5 - Sound Families

/ai/	/ee/	/igh/	/oa/	/oo/	/y-oo/
/r/	/n/	/m/	/ch/	/k/	/sh/
/j/	/v/	/u/	/e/	/i/	/s/
/zh/ /z/	/ar/	/or/	/ur/	/air/	/ear/

The book title “Paint in the Rain” covers the long vowel sound family of /ai/, where alternative spellings are provided for /ai/: /ay/, /a/, /a-e/.

This book also supports other key reading strategies:

- Recognising the relationship between words and illustrations.
- Building fluency skills.
- Vocabulary and word study.

This book also supports key comprehension strategies:

- Predicting the meanings of new or unfamiliar words from the context of the story;
- Recognising the relationship between letters and their sound families;
- Summarising the main ideas of the story.

Introducing the Text

Open up the discussion about the front cover illustration and make connections with the children’s prior knowledge. Prompt discussions by using the vocabulary in the book.

What does the title of the story tell you about the front cover image?

Describe the character on the front cover.

Look at the sound family notation /ai/ on the front cover and identify where this features in the book title.

Look at the phonemes highlighted on the front inner cover. Review the sound family table together.

Reading the Text

Pages 2 and 3 – Before reading begins, discuss the setting of the story and make predictions about the changes in weather and what effect this might have on the painter’s experience. Review the target sound family listed in the front inner cover and identify the highlighted words in the book text as examples of the sound family.

Pages 4 and 5 – Here, the character starts to paint. Discuss what is happening to the artist's painting in the rain. What is the meaning of the word 'drizzle'?

Pages 6 and 7 – Continue to review the target sound /ai/ and identify the word examples which are related to this sound family. Can you hear the similarities in the sounds and see the differences in spellings within the words? Can you think of other example words which contain these sounds.

Page 8 – The illustration on the final page is the artist enjoying himself while he paints in the rain. Identify the rhyme and repetition of the target sound family within the text on the final page.

Children can now read the book independently and fluently. At the end of the story, go over the text and illustrations again and discuss what is happening on each page.

Revisit the target sound family /ai/ being taught in this title.

Revisiting the Text

As a group, refer back at the phoneme table in the front inner cover and identify the words in the story that have been highlighted. The target phoneme has been highlighted in the text as it can be represented by various different graphemes or spelling patterns, representing a sound family.

Following Up

Use the BM for this story, the students can learn more about the long vowel Sound Family for /ai/.